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The New York Times



Fleeing the southern outskirts of Beirut, Lebanon, on Monday as Israel said it would bombard the area, a stronghold for Hezbollah.

Lebanon’s Best Chance at Disarming Hezbollah Only Crumbled

By ABDI LATIF DAHIR and AARON BOXERMAN

BEIRUT, Lebanon — Early this year, Lebanon’s leaders seemed to be edging toward one of their most elusive goals: disarming Hezbollah, the powerful Iran-backed militia that has long operated as a state within a state.

That effort — tentative and incremental from the start — has now stalled.

After more than a year of largely holding its fire, despite Israeli strikes from across the border, Hezbollah re-emerged as a major combatant. In March, after the

United States and Israel began their war with Iran, Hezbollah began cross-border attacks on Israel in solidarity with its patron, and it has killed several Israeli soldiers.

Now, Lebanon is trapped in a familiar position. Israel has intensified its military campaign against Hezbollah, making the group even less likely to disarm. And Lebanon’s government, wary of Hezbollah’s enduring strength and haunted by memories of civil war, has recoiled from the idea of forcibly seizing its arsenal, despite Western pressure to do so.

On Monday, the Israeli government announced plans to bom-

Militants Re-Entrench After War in Iran and Attacks by Israel

bard the southern outskirts of Beirut, and Hezbollah claimed new attacks against Israeli soldiers and communities — reflecting how a cease-fire declared by the Trump administration in April increasingly exists only on paper.

With hundreds of thousands displaced by the fighting and Israel occupying parts of southern

Lebanon, many Lebanese worry that any strife between the government and Hezbollah would deepen the country’s turmoil and reopen old wounds.

“Any coercive or confrontational process from the army will be complicated because it would require a nonconsensual decision, which is very much against the grain of Lebanese politics,” said Heiko Wimmen, the project director for Lebanon at the International Crisis Group, a research organization.

Another obstacle is Iran itself. Though battered by two wars

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Judges Express Dwindling Trust In Justice Dept.

By MATTATHIAS SCHWARTZ

In late April, a lawyer for the Justice Department told a federal judge that her colleagues had been in the midst of negotiations with a Rhode Island hospital about turning over gender-transition treatment health records, only for the hospital’s lawyers to stop responding.

But Judge Mary S. McElroy of Federal District Court in Rhode Island concluded that was not true. While the government claimed it had not heard from the hospital since February, emails showed the hospital’s lawyers had stayed in close touch.

In a scathing ruling on May 14, Judge McElroy called the government’s account “misleading, if not utterly false.” At issue in Judge McElroy’s view was the “awesome power” wielded by government lawyers and the trust that they will “play fair and be honest” with courts.

The Justice Department “has proven unworthy of this trust at every point in this case,” she wrote.

The opinion was one of several heated rulings from federal judges in recent weeks castigating the government’s lawyers for withholding information and making assertions that turned out to be at odds with the facts.

A judge in Chicago said transcripts of grand jury proceedings had been redacted to hide misconduct by her district’s U.S. attorney’s office. Another judge in Rhode Island referred an assistant U.S. attorney for potential dis-

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DANG VAN PHUOC, 1935-2026



The A.P. photographer depicted bravery and terror on the front lines of the Vietnam War. Page B10.

Progressive Faith Powers Texas Democrat’s Run

By RUTH GRAHAM and J. DAVID GOODMAN

On a recent Sunday morning at St. Andrew’s Presbyterian Church in Austin, Texas, Jim Rigby asked his congregation to share what came to mind when he mentioned the Apostle Paul, the major Christian figure to whom 13 books in the Bible are attributed. They cheerfully complied:

“Villain!”

“Homophobic!”

“He’s a jerk.”

Paul’s attributed writings in-

Evangelicals See Threat in Talarico’s Pastor

clude passages seen as encouraging wives to submit to their husbands and instructing them to be quiet in church, and others condemning same-sex sexual behavior as sinful.

Mr. Rigby acknowledged the trouble. But in a sermon that also cited the Bhagavad Gita and the Buddha, he nudged his congrega-

tion to reconsider the apostle, one of the most important in the early Christian church. “Aristotle and Plato, they were creeps, too, in modern times,” Mr. Rigby said. “But do we want to learn from our ancestors or not?”

One longtime member of St. Andrew’s was not there, although he had attended the previous weekend: James Talarico, the Democratic nominee for Senate. Mr. Rigby, who has led St. Andrew’s since the 1980s and is a well-known activist locally, has sud-

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In Stalemates, Trump’s Talk Meets Reality

Lessons Sting in Gaza, Ukraine and Now Iran

By DAVID E. SANGER

WASHINGTON — President Trump likes his military and diplomatic victories quick, clean and decisive.

On his desk in the Oval Office, he keeps models of the B-2 bombers that took out three Iranian nuclear sites in one night, not quite a year ago. In the opening weeks of the Iran conflict this year, he talked often about replicating his success in Venezuela — “the perfect scenario,” he said — shorthand for overthrowing a troublesome leader with one quick commando raid, and replacing him with a pliant, American-friendly successor.

But now, Mr. Trump has hit the stalemate phase of his presidency.

The war with Iran is clearly at that stage. When he declared a cease-fire on April 7, Mr. Trump said on social media that the end of combat operations would be conditional on “the COMPLETE, IMMEDIATE, and SAFE OPENING of the Strait of Hormuz.” It wasn’t. Even if commerce now resumes across the strait under a memorandum of understanding still under negotiation, it will still leave the future of Iran’s nuclear and missile programs exactly where they were in February: stuck in a further negotiation that the administration insists will be “time limited,” probably to 60 days.

But the Iranians sense Mr. Trump’s deep reluctance to restart combat operations that are deeply unpopular in the United States, and most Iran experts say they expect Tehran to try to stretch the negotiations for months or years — as they have with past administrations.

Then there is the Ukraine war, a conflict in its fifth year that Mr. Trump boasted he would end in 24 hours after taking office. Sixteen months after he was sworn in, he rarely mentions the war anymore, and Secretary of State Marco Rubio recently complained that he was tired of wasting time in endless negotiations, suggesting that he would

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LEBANON President Trump said Israel and Hezbollah had agreed not to attack each other. PAGE A9

THE WEATHER

Today, sunshine and clouds, light winds, high 76. **Tonight**, clear sky, light winds, low 59. **Tomorrow**, sunshine and a few clouds, a breeze, high 78. Weather map, Page B12.

PRESIDENT SAID TO BE DROPPING PLANS FOR FUND

BACKLASH IN CONGRESS

Critics Feared \$1.8 Billion Would Be Diverted to His Political Allies

This article is by Tyler Pager, Maggie Haberman, Alan Feuer, Devin Barrett and Annie Karni.

WASHINGTON — President Trump is backing off his plan to establish a \$1.8 billion fund to compensate people who claimed they were victims of unfair prosecution by the government, two people familiar with the matter said on Monday.

The people, who spoke on condition of anonymity to describe the president’s thinking, said he had been leaning for days toward scrapping the fund, which critics have characterized as a scheme to reward Mr. Trump’s political allies with public benefits.

The administration signaled a retreat on Monday, when the Justice Department said in a statement that it would abide by a federal judge’s temporary order not to proceed with any steps to activate the fund until at least June 12, when a hearing on the fund is scheduled. The department said the administration disagreed with the decision but did not make clear whether it intended to fight the issue further in court.

It was unclear whether getting rid of the fund would affect another part of the legal settlement in the case, which provides Mr. Trump, his family and his businesses with significant immunity from audits.

Still, some administration officials privately expressed relief that the judge’s ruling showed a way out of what most had seen as a mess of the Trump team’s own making. But as with all things involving Mr. Trump, he could still decide to reverse course, especially as he tracks media coverage of his decision.

The decision by Mr. Trump to back down — at least for now — comes after rare pushback from members of his own party, who normally fall in line behind him. Some Republicans on Monday were looking for assurances that the president would actually follow through with killing off the fund, which likely would have distributed huge sums to Mr. Trump’s allies.

The White House referred to the Justice Department’s state-

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Lutnick Runs Commerce Dept. With Bare-Knuckles Approach

By MICHAEL ROTHFELD and ANA SWANSON

When auto executives learned last year that President Trump’s punishing tariffs on foreign car parts were set to cost their companies billions of dollars, they were rattled.

Eager to lessen the blow, they began calling and visiting Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick in his spacious, wood-paneled office near the White House, where they negotiated, complained and cajoled in talks that stretched on for months.

Then, in October, there came a breakthrough: Mr. Lutnick and his aides informed the automakers that the administration would offer a credit on auto part tariffs for American-made cars, retroactive to when the levies began in May 2025, according to six industry executives, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe private discussions.

What happened next would



Howard Lutnick, secretary of commerce, on Capitol Hill.

leave them flabbergasted, with billions of dollars fewer than they had anticipated — and would drive home the sense that Mr. Lutnick, a 64-year-old billionaire, was a commerce secretary unlike any in recent memory.

In a freewheeling first year in office, Mr. Lutnick, one of President Trump’s most influential dep-

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SPORTS B6-9

A Return for Serena Williams

The 23-time Grand Slam singles champion, out since 2022, will play doubles at a Wimbledon tuneup at 44. PAGE B7

The Knicks’ Retro Grit

The sons of Dave DeBusschere, who led two N.B.A. title runs, see a lot of their father in the current team. PAGE B7

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War Crime Charges for Syrians

The trial, Austria’s first against Assad regime officials, will be a chance for Syrian witnesses to confront two men they have accused of torture. PAGE A6

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Trans Troops Win Reprieve

A court blocked the administration from removing 28 transgender service members from the military. PAGE A17

Redistricting Wallops Races

Thanks to gerrymandering, competitive districts in the House of Representatives are increasingly rare. PAGE A14



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Taking ‘Euphoria’ to the End

The show’s creator, Sam Levinson, explains why he figures it is time to bring the HBO show to a close. PAGE C1

Black Culture With ‘90s Vibe

A two-day event held at a seaside amusement park channels an earlier era of Black British nightlife. PAGE C1

BUSINESS B1-5

Anthropic Files to Go Public

The artificial intelligence company, which is racing OpenAI to the stock market, has set the stage for vast investment after having explosive growth over the last year. PAGE B1

There’s A.I., but No Layoffs

Unlike many large companies, a French manufacturer decided to use artificial intelligence to make its call center and factory workers more productive, rather than to replace them. PAGE B1

OPINION A18-19

Frank Bruni PAGE A19



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Dispute Over Contamination

A lawsuit over pollutants from a military base in New Mexico may have a nationwide effect. Above, Christopher Witt with a duck he would test. PAGE D8

